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315 units. 15 years. Still no shovel in the ground.

The Terraces of Lafayette in 4 pages — what's approved, where it actually stands, and what it means if you rent, buy, or own nearby.

315

APARTMENTS APPROVED

63

BELOW-MARKET UNITS

0

BUILDINGS UNDER CONSTRUCTION

Approved. Not being built.

The developer's website reads like a project that's happening. The city's permit record says otherwise.

- Lafayette's development register lists it as **approved, not under construction**.
- At the June 22, 2026 council hearing, the city planner confirmed the main construction permits are **approved but not issued**.
- The site is still ten separate parcels. They must be merged into one before anything gets built.

PERMIT STATUS

Done	Project approval & use permit (2020)	Not issued	Mass grading permit
Done	Tree removal (Sept 2024)	Not issued	Retaining walls
Done	Phase I grading — drainage (2024)	Not issued	Vertical build — 14 buildings

02 — HOW IT GOT HERE

Fifteen years, two ballot fights, one Supreme Court.

2011	O'Brien Land Company files for 315 apartments on 22 acres.
2013	Environmental review certified. City floats a 44-home alternative instead.
2018	Voters kill the alternative (Measure L). The apartment plan comes back.
2020	City Council approves it at 12:45am after two nights of hearings.
2021–22	Save Lafayette sues. Appeals court sides with the project.
2023	CA Supreme Court declines review. Litigation over.
2024	Trees cleared. Minor drainage grading done. Mass grading never starts.
2026	You are here — approved, permitted on paper, nothing built.

What would actually go there.

14

BUILDINGS — 7 AT THREE
STOREYS, 7 AT TWO

1–3

BEDROOM PLANS

22_{ac}

3233 DEER HILL ROAD

1.5_{mi}

TO LAFAYETTE BART

- **All 315 units are rentals.** None are for sale.
- **63 units are deed-restricted** to households at or below 80% of area median income. Rents for the other 252 have not been published.
- Plus a clubhouse, leasing office and on-site recreation.
- Site is the SW corner of Deer Hill and Pleasant Hill Rd, next to Acalanes High School, just north of Highway 24.
- Approved road work includes a new dedicated right-turn lane on southbound Pleasant Hill Rd onto the Hwy 24 westbound on-ramp.

Both sides, straight.

The case for

- Lafayette has very little rental housing and almost no deed-restricted housing.
 - 1.5 miles from BART — the transit-adjacent infill regional plans call for.
 - Kids who grew up here and seniors downsizing both have to leave to find a rental.
 - Courts have repeatedly upheld the city's approval.
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The case against

- Wildfire evacuation — opponents argue 315 more households could push evacuation past 40 minutes.
 - Traffic at what they call the city's most impacted intersection.
 - The general plan designates that ridgeline a scenic entryway.
 - It would be the largest apartment complex of its kind in Lafayette.
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What this means for you.

If you're renting in Lamorinda

- **Don't plan around it.** Even from the day grading starts, you're 2–3 years from keys.
- The 63 below-market units are worth tracking. Deed-restricted inventory in the Acalanes district is rare and will be competitive.

If you're buying nearby

- Treat it as a disclosure item — know what you're buying next to, in writing.
- **The value impact is smaller than people assume.** Acalanes buyers are buying schools, commute and scarce detached inventory. A rental community a mile off doesn't move those.

If you already own there

- **Don't panic-sell ahead of it.** This has been “about to happen” since 2011. That's a weak reason to trigger a taxable event and rebuy into a pricier market.
- Know your number instead — today's value vs. value with 315 units built. In this corridor the gap is usually smaller than sellers expect.

The bigger signal

- A fully entitled, court-validated project in a prime zip code still can't break ground after 15 years. **That's the whole East Bay supply story** — and why pressure keeps pushing out to Walnut Creek, Concord, Martinez, Brentwood and Antioch, where land and entitlements actually exist.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Let's talk about your situation.

Thirty minutes. Where you're trying to end up, what your place is worth today, and what the market's doing in the pocket you actually care about. No pitch — if the answer is wait, I'll tell you that.

[Book a 30-minute strategy call →](#)

[Call 925-390-8768](tel:925-390-8768)

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Verify live status & sources: [City of Lafayette](#) · [Lafayette development register](#) · [Lamorinda Weekly, Aug 2026](#) · [CBS SF](#) · [SFGATE](#) · [Developer site](#) · [Save Lafayette](#)

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